

Halden Foods • Annual Packaging Terms

NEGOTIATION WITH RIDGELINE PACK CO. • 74 MINUTES • PROCESSED FROM TRANSCRIPT AND TWO FOLLOW-UP EMAILS

What it pulled together: the live transcript, the recap Ridgeline sent that evening, and your buyer's internal note the next morning, cross-referenced against the four open commitments from this account. One commercial detail that nobody flagged in the room is surfaced below. Decisions and owners are reconciled across all three sources, not just the call.

Decisions logged

Four things were settled in the room. Each is captured as agreed, with the source that confirms it.

Term locked at 24 months, not 36

AGREED

You held on flexibility • Ridgeline conceded in exchange for an earlier volume commitment

Corrugated and folding carton priced as separate lines

AGREED

No more blended rate • each SKU family quoted on its own sheet going forward

Annual price review capped at the published resin index, plus two points

AGREED

Replaces the open-ended "market adjustment" clause from the prior contract

Tooling cost for the new tray amortized over the first 400,000 units

AGREED

Ridgeline carries it; recovered through unit price, not invoiced up front

Action items

Every commitment from the call, with the owner and the date it is due. Split across both sides so nothing waits on a name you forgot to assign.

Send the corrected line-item pricing sheet

RIDGELINE · D. CASTELLANO

DUE JUN 24

Both formats on one rate, units stated consistently
· this is the detail flagged below

Confirm the resin index source in writing

RIDGELINE · D. CASTELLANO

DUE JUN 26

Which published index, which monthly print, who reads it · referenced in their recap but never named

Circulate the 24-month volume schedule for sign-off

HALDEN · YOU

BLOCKING

The commitment Ridgeline took the shorter term for · finance needs to see it before you sign

Run the tray tooling amortization against the demand forecast

HALDEN · S. OKAFOR, OPS

DUE JUN 27

Confirm 400,000 units clears inside year one or the per-unit recovery shifts

Pull the prior contract's adjustment-clause history

HALDEN · LEGAL

DUE JUN 30

For legal to confirm the new cap actually closes the old escalator

Send the redline of the master supply agreement

RIDGELINE · COUNSEL

DUE JUL 1

Reflecting the four decisions above · their counsel turns it within five business days

Schedule the sign-off call

HALDEN · YOU

DRAFT SENT

Once the corrected sheet and the volume schedule are both in hand

The detail worth catching

One number was quoted two different ways in the same conversation. It read as a concession. It was not.

The corrugated rate was quoted per thousand units; the folding carton rate, per unit. The room compared them as if they matched.

On the call, Castellano said corrugated was landing at **\$182** and folding carton at **\$0.21**, and the conversation moved on as though folding carton was the cheaper line. In their evening recap email, both appeared in one column with no unit label. Read straight across, folding carton looks like a fraction of the corrugated cost.

Normalized to the same basis, corrugated is **\$0.182** per unit and folding carton is **\$0.21** per unit. Folding carton is the more expensive line, not the cheaper one. At your projected **3.1M** folding carton units, treating the recap figure as already-per-unit-comparable would have understated that line by roughly **\$87,000** across the term. Surfaced before you sign, not after the first quarter's invoices reconcile.

Drafted for you

Two follow-ups are written and waiting in your drafts, each in your voice. Review, adjust, send.

Recap to Ridgeline confirming the four decisions

DRAFT

Restates the term, the separate line pricing, the index cap, and the tooling treatment · and asks, plainly, for the corrected sheet with units stated on every line

Internal note to your COO

DRAFT

One paragraph on where the deal landed, one on the per-unit catch and the \$87K it would have cost · framed as resolved, not alarming

Still open

Two threads need a decision from you before this can close.

Do you sign the volume schedule before or after the tooling math comes back?

YOUR CALL

Ridgeline took the 24-month term for the volume commitment · if the 400,000-unit amortization slips, the per-unit price moves and the schedule should reflect it. Signing first is faster; signing second is cleaner.

Hold the index cap at two points, or push for one?

YOUR CALL

They conceded the structure readily, which suggests room. One more point is worth roughly \$19K a year at current volume. Worth a single ask before counsel finalizes the redline.

COMMAND ROOM • MEETING NOTES • RECONCILED FROM TRANSCRIPT AND
FOLLOW-UP EMAIL • NAMES AND FIGURES ARE ILLUSTRATIVE